



Time Management and Study Skills

LDP Global Resource Curriculum

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Objectives

At the end of these lessons, you will be able to:

- Make a realistic weekly schedule and prioritize activities
- Demonstrate effective study habits
- Explain and demonstrate effective test-taking skills

Resources

For additional information, please see the following Equip modules:

- The Leader's Time: Tick Tock, Manage the Clock
- Priorities and Decision Making

Unless otherwise indicated, all Scripture is taken from the New International Version of the Holy Bible.

Please note: Due to copyright laws, during contextualization and translation any excerpts taken directly from a resource may not be altered in any fashion.

Lesson 1: Time Management

Objective: At the end of this lesson, you will be able to make a realistic weekly schedule and prioritize all of your activities.

Individual Study

Preparation

Suggested time: 15 minutes

Time is important to God and very important for you to use wisely to accomplish all that God has for you to do!

1. Read **Ecclesiastes 3:1-13:**

¹ There is a time for everything, and a season for every activity under heaven:

² a time to be born and a time to die, a time to plant and a time to uproot, ³ a time to kill and a time to heal, a time to tear down and a time to build, ⁴ a time to weep and a time to laugh, a time to mourn and a time to dance, ⁵ a time to scatter stones and a time to gather them, a time to embrace and a time to refrain, ⁶ a time to search and a time to give up, a time to keep and a time to throw away, ⁷ a time to tear and a time to mend, a time to be silent and a time to speak, ⁸ a time to love and a time to hate, a time for war and a time for peace.

⁹ What does the worker gain from his toil? ¹⁰ I have seen the burden God has laid on men. ¹¹ He has made everything beautiful in its time. He has also set eternity in the hearts of men; yet they cannot fathom what God has done from beginning to end.

¹² I know that there is nothing better for men than to be happy and do good while they live. ¹³ That everyone may eat and drink, and find satisfaction in all his toil—this is the gift of God

2. Explain your answers to the following questions:

- What do you learn from God's perspective on time? How can you apply that to your life?
- Do you feel like you manage your time well, or do you feel overwhelmed and unable to accomplish things during the week?

3. Write a detailed list of activities that you do each day for a week.

- Detail the amount of time required for each activity.
 - Include time for transportation, eating, and socializing with friends; time for church and Bible reading; time for school activities, such as studying, meeting with tutor, and attending classes; and time for doing household chores, such as doing laundry, preparing a meal, etc.
4. Make a schedule using these seven categories:

Category	Comments
Family	If you live with your family, you may have chores or responsibilities at home.
Health	Mental and physical: Schedule time for relaxation to help manage stress.
Intellectual	The time you spend reading, studying, and completing class assignments.
Financial	You may need to work.
Professional	The time you spend volunteering or gaining experience in your vocation.
Social	The time you spend relaxing with friends, helping a friend with a problem, or investing in a relationship with a possible future mate.
Spiritual	The time you spend alone in personal devotion, prayer, and Bible reading and the time you spend meeting with other believers.

5. As you make your schedule, you may want to use 30- or 15-minute increments. Prioritize activities and make sure you allow enough time to accomplish the tasks that you must complete.

Discussion and Application

Personal Reflection

Suggested time: 30 minutes

1. Complete your schedule as follows:

Ask yourself this...	And then mark these in...
What activities are vital to my education?	Red
What activities are vital to my family? (If not living with your family, consider your own personal relationships with roommate or friends.)	Green
What activities are vital to my relationship	Yellow

Ask yourself this...	And then mark these in...
with God?	
What activities are vital to my mental and physical health?	Blue
- Do you spend too much time in one area and not enough time in another? - Do you see activities that are unrelated to these four important areas? Maybe you shouldn't be spending time on those activities.	
2. Write down your goals for the week.	
- What activities help you reach your goals? - Do some activities take away from time you should be spending on those goals? - What can you improve or change to ensure that you are using your time wisely so that you can reach your goals?	

Mentor Discussion

Suggested time: 10-20 minutes

1. Show your mentor the schedule you made for the week. Let your mentor give suggestions of ways to create more personal or study time in your schedule. You may want to work together to create a schedule for the entire month.
2. Ask your mentor:
 - Am I trying to do too much in a day or week?
 - What activities could I eliminate to create time for unexpected activities or opportunities?
 - What activities should be a top priority to help me towards my career?
 - How can I achieve a better balance of activities in my schedule?

Care Group Discussion

Suggested time: 15-30 minutes

Spend time together discussing the following questions about schedules:

1. **What scheduled items or activities are the hardest to accomplish?**

Set up accountability between members of the group who struggle in an area and members who are successful in that area.

Example: One member has difficulty staying on task studying and another member studies efficiently. The member doing well could encourage and offer study tips to the other or could possibly set up a study time together.

2. What strategies could help you avoid time wasters?

Let group members share successful strategies to avoid wasting time.

3. Why would time spent with God actually help me accomplish more in my schedule?

Discuss ways a deeper relationship with God brings strength, power, guidance, and daily help. Use Bibles to look up the following scriptures:

Philippians 4:6-7

Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.

2 Corinthians 12:9

But he said to me, "My grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in weakness." Therefore I will boast all the more gladly about my weaknesses, so that Christ's power may rest on me.

Ephesians 6:10

Finally, be strong in the Lord and in his mighty power.

Lesson 2: Study Skills

Objective: At the end of this lesson, you will be able to demonstrate effective study habits.

Individual Study

Suggested time: 15 minutes

Review effective ways to study using memorization and other study techniques.

Memorization

Method 1:

1. Write the information out in small sections.
2. Memorize the first section.
3. Memorize the second section, and then memorize with first and second sections together.
4. Continue adding one section at a time, always adding to the previously learned sections.

Method 2:

1. Write out all of the information you need to memorize.
2. Read through the passage several times, stopping to work on memorizing the information in smaller sections.
3. Erase a small number of important words scattered throughout the passage.
4. Once you can read through the information and easily fill in the missing words, erase another set of key words.
5. Read through the passage until you can easily remember the missing words, and then start the process again.

Other Techniques

1. Create actions or motions for the material being studied.
2. Draw pictures to represent key ideas or concepts.
3. Use a common/popular musical tune or rhythm and exchange the words with information that needs to be learned.

Using Note Cards

1. Prepare for an essay question. Take a blank note card or piece of paper.
 - A. On the front of the card, write the topic.
 - B. On the back of the card, list all the important facts that should be included in the essay question.
2. Study the note card.
 - A. Look at the front of the card, read the word aloud, and try to say the definition or other information written on the back.
 - B. When you have learned well most of the information, turn the cards over. Read what is on the back of the card and then name the topic written on the front of the card.

Using Other Study Skills

1. Read the chapter.
2. If there are questions at the end of a chapter in the book or on a worksheet, answer them.
3. Read through all class notes.
4. Make a practice test and then go back and answer the questions. If you have a study partner from the class, trade practice tests and help each other understand any missed questions.
5. Use these tips to memorize specific facts, lines, etc.:
 - A. Start by learning the first two or three items, then add another fact and say all of the facts that you have already learned.
 - B. Once you can recite fluently those lines or facts, add another line and start the process again until you have memorized all of the material.
 - C. Try to say all lines/facts again a few hours later or the next morning.
 - D. Go back and focus on any material that you still don't understand completely or have memorized.
 - E. Keep reviewing the material using these techniques until you take the test.
6. Use these tips for memorizing a large paragraph or section of notes:
 - A. Start by rewriting the information on a piece of paper.
 - B. Study the material until the information is very familiar.

- C. Use the page with the rewritten information and erase a few words or phrases. Choose the hardest words or the sections that are the most important to learn well.
- D. Read through the notes and fill in the blanks.
- E. Continue erasing and filling in answers until you have memorized all of the words and information.

Discussion and Application

Personal Reflection

Suggested time: 10-15 minutes

1. After reviewing the study skills, think about how you spend time studying. Studying impacts your education more when you consider the importance of learning in your life.
 - How does studying and learning benefit me now? In the future?
 - How might my relationship with God affect my attitude towards studying?
 - How do I feel when I know I've studied well? How do I feel when I know I have not studied well?
2. Take time to consider where you study and what distractions may be hindering your study time.
 - Where do I study? How can I create an area where I can study more efficiently?
 - How much time do I spend studying? Do I use the study time efficiently or do I waste time?
 - How can I be more efficient during my study time?
3. Studying is more effective when you involve more of your senses and use several methods to convey the information, such as visual (seeing the words or pictures or using color for emphasis as you write your notes); auditory (hearing yourself say or sing the words); and physical movement (using hand motions or acting out a concept).

Use at least two of the different study skills to help you grasp the material in various ways.

- Which senses do I usually use for studying? How could I use other senses as I study?
- Which study skill do I typically use the most effectively?

- Which study skill do I typically use the least effectively? How can I improve using that skill?
- Which study skill does not work for me? Why? Does it matter?

Mentor Discussion

Suggested time: 10-20 minutes

1. When you meet with your mentor, show him or her the list of study skills. Discuss the benefits or limitations of the skills to your specific educational experience. Let your mentor suggest study skill techniques for you to try.
2. Ask your mentor to spend time helping you study a topic that is difficult or challenging for you.

Care Group Discussion

Suggested time: 15-30 minutes

Study together by doing the following:

1. Bring paper to make note cards to help study for a test. Highlight key words in color and draw pictures to help you visualize the concept.
2. Quiz each other on material you are studying.
3. Work together to create rhymes, songs or chants, or actions.
4. After spending time helping each other study, ask these questions:
 - Which new study skills have you tried successfully?
 - How can we help each other study?
 - Set up a calendar or chart that shows the class schedules and when the students taking the classes are available to study together.
 - Coordinate your schedules and hold each other accountable to maximize your study time.
 - How is God honored when I study?
5. Read 2 Timothy 2:15 (KJV)

Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.
6. Pray for each student's study time to be effective, for God to receive glory through the time spent studying, and for the students to reap the rewards of studying.

Lesson 3: Test-Taking Skills

Objective: After completing this lesson, you will be able to explain and demonstrate effective test-taking skills.

Individual Study

Suggested time: 15 minutes

Good test taking skills are vital to your success in school. Review the following test-taking skills. Note any areas that you don't understand or any questions you have concerning these skills. Talk with your mentor or care group to help you completely master these skills.

True/False Questions

1. When taking true/false tests, it is important to read the statements carefully. If any part of the sentence is not true, the answer is false.
2. Carefully watch for words that are negatives, for example, *no*, *not*, and *cannot*. To help make one of these statements less confusing, do the following:
 - A. Read it without the negative.
 - B. Decide whether the "new" statement is true or false.
 - C. If it is true, the opposite (negative) is generally false.
3. Look for words that are qualifiers. These words restrict or broaden general statements, for example, *sometimes*, *often*, *frequently*, *ordinarily*, and *generally*. Qualifiers:
 - Open up the possibility of making accurate statements
 - Make more modest claims and are more likely to reflect reality
 - Usually indicate "true" answers
4. Watch for absolute words, which restrict possibilities, for example, *no*, *never*, *none*, *always*, *every*, *entirely*, and *only*. Absolute words:
 - Imply the statement must be true 100% of the time
 - Usually indicate "false" answers
5. Slow down for long sentences, which often include groups of words that are set off by punctuation.

- To make the best selection, pay attention to the “truth” of each of these phrases.
 - You may even want to underline or otherwise mark each phrase.
 - If one of the phrases is false, it usually indicates a “false” answer.
6. When guessing, use these tips:
- Teachers want you to see the right information more than the wrong information.
 - More of the statements will be true than false.
 - If you are 90% sure of an answer, choose that response.
 - If you are unsure of an answer, guessing “true” often provides a more than 50% chance of getting the answer correct.
 - Some teachers may do the reverse and have more false questions.
 - If you have taken a similar test in this teacher’s class before, review the exams to look for a pattern.
7. As with all tests, it is important to read the instructions carefully.
- How are you supposed to indicate your answers? Circle True or False, write “True or False,” write “T” or “F” or something else?
 - Do you only have to decide whether the question is true or false or is there another step?
 - Do you need to change false questions to make them true?
 - Have you been instructed to underline the false phrase?
 - Are there any other special instructions?
8. Go back and double-check the answers before turning in your paper. Make sure that you have:
- Followed directions
 - Answered every question
 - Read the question correctly

Be careful though—research has shown that when you are unsure of an answer, your first response is more likely to be correct. If you guessed originally and are thinking about changing your guess, it is generally best to leave your first answer.

Multiple-Choice Questions

Multiple-choice questions generally start with a question, statement, story, or illustration to be considered. This information is followed by a list of possible answers from which you are to select the answer.

1. Start by reading the instructions carefully.
 - Is there only one answer per question, or are you allowed to select more than one answer for a given question?
 - How are you supposed to indicate your answer? Circle or rewrite?
2. As you read each question, stop at the end of the question and see if you know the answer before reading the choices. If you think you do, read all of the choices, choose the one closest to your answer, and continue with the next question.
3. If you are not confident of the answer, read the choices, and if the correct answer is immediately obvious, select that answer and proceed to the next question.
4. If the correct answer is not immediately obvious, try some of these techniques:
 - Narrow your choices by eliminating answers that are obviously wrong because they are almost identical.
 - Avoid choosing answers that use specific determiners such as *everyone*, *always*, *never*, etc.
 - Choose answers that use qualifying terms such as *often*, *most*, etc.
 - Beware of questions containing *no*, *not*, or *none*. These words easily change the meaning of questions.
 - Look for questions where the wording does not match the wording in the question (such as grammatical inconsistencies).
 - Choose the longest, most precise answer.
 - Choose the answer that is in the middle.
 - Choose the answer which first caught your eye.

Note: These techniques work best when used together.

5. When guessing, use these tips:

- A. When taking the test, do not be discouraged if you cannot answer a question. Leave it and go on. You may find the answer or clues to the answer in subsequent questions.
 - B. When you have finished the rest of the test, return to the unanswered questions and use the guessing tips.
6. Like with every exam, when you have finished it, read back through all of the instructions and questions.
- Make sure you have followed all instructions and answered all questions.
 - Do not be afraid to change an answer if you feel strongly about it.
 - If you are not really sure, leave the original answer. Research shows it is most likely correct.

Short-Answer Questions

Teachers often use short-answer questions when they want you to prove you know the information without being provided the answers.

1. Make sure you understand the question. Often short-answer questions fall under one of the following categories:
 - A long question with a short answer
 - Read the question carefully.
 - Carefully distinguish between the relevant information and the extra information.
 - A short question with a long answer
 - Underline or highlight the key points in the question.
 - This is particularly important for essay questions that ask you to address several points.

2. Understand the key words that you may find in short-answer questions:

Key Words	Description
Compare and Contrast	The question will always involve two or more related items. - Compare - Explain the similarities between the two items. Typically, instructors want explanations of the characteristics and how they are similar, not just a list of the characteristics. - Contrast - Explain the differences between the two items. Typically instructors want you to include a comparison of both similarities and differences that highlight major concepts in the given topic. They may also want you to use specific examples from class.
Describe, Discuss, or Explain	Explain the topic and give support for your explanation. Generally requires writing out sentences and complete thoughts to answer well, instead of writing simple phrases or definitions.
Define	Define a word or phrase, making sure that the definition that you write makes sense with the topic you are studying. Usually you don't need a thorough explanation.
List	Create a simple list of concepts or terms; use numbers or bullets to clarify where each new item begins.
Interpret	Explain the meaning of a chart, graph, or illustration by putting the data or figure into words.
Diagram, Draw, or Illustrate	Make a simple drawing, labeling it where appropriate.

3. Plan out your answer before you begin writing. This step may seem like a waste of time. However, it is a greater waste of time to write unnecessary information or to erase and re-write. You can plan by drawing a picture, creating a quick outline, etc. Using these tools:

- Will remind you of key points to include
- Can help you focus your answers on the important information and avoid unnecessary information

Typically short-answer questions:

- Are meant to have shorter answers

- Demand a clear and well-educated answer, but not always complete sentences or paragraphs
 - Can sometimes be answered with logically organized lists of sentence fragments, labeled illustrations, etc.
4. Convey your thoughts in an organized and succinct manner. Typically, your teacher will grade the answers on the information that they contain, not on how creatively you write the answers.
- Clearly state the key points to your answer and make them obvious to the reader; don't bury them in a paragraph of irrelevant information.
 - Avoid including information that does not directly support your answer.
5. Support the statements you make by using:
- Relevant technical terminology
 - Terminology specific to the topic at hand
 - Studies/data/statistics directly related to the question
 - Cause and effect relationships. Clearly state both the cause and effect.
 - Illustrations, charts, or diagrams to support your point. Make sure these drawings clarify your answer.
 - Evidence and/or examples from class lectures and readings
6. Avoid the following:
- Including too much information
 - Writing a good answer that does not answer the question asked
 - Expecting the teacher to figure out:
 - The main points you included
 - What you mean by a diagram or how a detail is related to the question
 - Whether you really know the answer or you're trying to "fake" your way through

Essay Questions

Typically, great essay questions are compact, complete, clear, and organized. They:

- Take more time to answer

- Require one or more written paragraphs for a complete answer
- Demand higher quality in content and writing skills to earn full point value
- Require careful time management:
 - Planning (small amount)
 - Writing (most of time)
 - Reviewing (medium amount)

Typically instructors expect you to:

- Include well-written responses
- Include support for the statements that you make or opinions that you express
- Use good writing skills, such as correct grammar, spelling, and punctuation

Steps for Completing Essays

1. Preview the test by reading all of the questions. Make sure you understand what the instructor is asking.
2. Understand the key words that you may find in essay questions, which can increase your success. When you see these words, circle, highlight, or underline them as reminders when preparing answers to essay questions.

Key Words	Description
Analyze	▪ Break into separate parts. ▪ Discuss, examine, or interpret each part.
Compare and Contrast	The question will always involve two or more related items. ▪ Compare - Explain the similarities between the two items. Typically, instructors want explanations of the characteristics and how they are similar, not just a list of the characteristics. ▪ Contrast - Explain the differences between the two items. Typically instructors want you to include a comparison of both similarities and differences that highlight major concepts in the given topic. They may also want you to use specific examples from class.
Criticize	▪ Make judgments. ▪ Evaluate comparative worth. ▪ Analyze.
Define	▪ Give the meaning, usually a meaning specific to the course or subject. ▪ Determine the precise limits of the term to be

Key Words	Description
	defined. ▪ Explain the exact meaning. ▪ Keep definitions short.
Describe	▪ Give a detailed account. ▪ Make a picture with words. ▪ List characteristics, qualities, and parts.
Discuss	▪ Consider and debate or argue the pros and cons of an issue. ▪ Write about a conflict with good support details. ▪ Compare and contrast.
Explain	▪ Make an idea clear. ▪ Logically show how a concept is developed. ▪ Give the reasons for an event.
Interpret	Often this means: ▪ Explain what a chart, graph, or illustration means. ▪ Comment on, give examples of, and/or describe relationships between or among. ▪ Explain the meaning. ▪ Describe then evaluate. ▪ Put the data or figure into words.
Illustrate	Typically this does not mean to draw a picture, unless it is included as part of the question. Generally, it does mean you should: ▪ Give concrete examples ▪ Explain clearly by using comparisons or examples If you are asked to draw an illustration: ▪ Keep it simple. ▪ Label it whenever possible.
Outline	Describe main ideas, characteristics, or events.
Prove	Support with facts (especially facts presented in class or in the test).
Relate	▪ Show the connections between ideas or events. ▪ Provide a larger context.
Summarize	▪ Give a brief, condensed account. ▪ Include conclusions. ▪ Avoid unnecessary details.
Trace	Show the order of events or progress of a subject or event.
Evaluate	▪ Give your opinion or the opinion of an expert. ▪ Include evidence to support the evaluation.

3. Plan your time.

- Include time to answer all questions and read through all answers before turning in the exam.

- If six questions are to be answered in sixty minutes, allow yourself only seven minutes to answer each question.
 - If some questions hold higher values than others, prioritize time allocations with this in mind.
4. Start answering questions.
- A. Begin by answering the easiest questions.
 - B. Make a list of ideas and information that immediately comes to mind.
 - C. Organize your thoughts. You may want to:
 - Number the list of items in the order you will discuss them.
 - Make a simple outline. This will help keep your answer on the topic, help you judge the time needed to complete the question, and show the professor your organized thoughts that prove you know the answer.
 - Use a graphic organizer or other tool.
 - D. Get right to the point by writing a clear topic sentence that states your main point or idea.
 - E. Use your first paragraph to provide an overview of your essay.
 - F. Use the rest of your essay to discuss these points in more detail.
 - G. Back up your points with specific information, examples, or quotations from your readings and notes.
 - H. Try to write as neatly as possible and leave some space for added ideas or corrections.
 - I. When time is up for one question, stop writing, leave space, and begin the next question, even if you have not finished.
 - The incomplete answers can be completed during the review time.
 - Six incomplete answers will usually receive more credit than three complete ones.
5. Review your exam before turning it in.
- A. Complete questions left incomplete, but allow time to review all questions.
 - If you do not have time to finish some of the answers, outline the rest of them.
 - Typically, outlines with great content, facts, and details will receive more credit than if the question is barely started.

B. Review, edit, and correct:

- Misspellings
- Incomplete words, sentences, and ideas
- Miswritten dates and numbers

Math Questions

1. Preview the exam. Learn what is expected of you, prioritize test items, and pace yourself.
2. Carefully read instructions.
 - Make sure you are answering the question that is being asked! Often you know how to solve a problem, but you misread or misinterpret the question itself.
 - If you use a scratch piece of paper or have to complete the problem on a separate piece of paper, make sure that you correctly rewrite the problem.
3. Clearly write each step of the solution.
 - Don't skip steps.
 - Start from the beginning.
 - Be neat and don't rush writing numbers down. Neatness makes it easier to recheck your work.
 - Keep checking your solution as you are working.
4. Double-check your processes and calculations. Make sure you've included all needed labels, decimal points, etc. and have accurately answered the question asked.
5. If you get stuck on a problem, move on and come back to it later.
6. When finished, recheck all work.

Discussion and Application

Personal Reflection

Suggested time: 10-20 minutes

- Which type of questions on a test do you typically prefer? Why?
- Which type of questions do you typically struggle with or find more difficult? Why?
- What can you do to enhance your performance on these types of questions?

- Visualize yourself taking a test and implementing the test-taking skills. What changes do you visualize taking place?

Mentor Discussion

Suggested time: 10-20 minutes

1. Bring in any test questions that you found difficult to answer on a previous test. Ask your mentor to help you strategize how to improve your answer of that question. Learn tips that you can apply to future test questions.
2. If you struggle with essay questions, ask your mentor to help you formulate an answer to a question that might appear on a test for a class you are taking.
3. Ask your mentor these questions:
 - What strengths do you see in my test-taking skills?
 - How could I improve in my test-taking skills?

Care Group Discussion

Suggested time: 15-30 minutes

1. Have the students bring tests or typical test questions they have struggled to answer.
2. Spend time discussing these test-taking questions:
 - What type of test questions do you find most difficult?
 - What test-taking strategies have you tried?
 - Which strategies were most successful?
 - Which areas of test taking would you like to improve? How can we help you improve in those areas?
3. Let each person discuss the type of test questions that are difficult. Have the group members share any successful tips or strategies they have discovered. Let members who enjoy essay questions work with other members who struggle with essay questions.
4. Encourage each person to share the dates and times of upcoming tests and any concerns about the tests. Have the group members write down the dates on a calendar so that they will remember to pray for the person at that time. Also spend time praying for the specific concerns of each person.
5. What are some scriptures that will help during a test? Use Bibles to look up scriptures on topics such as peace,

trust, mind, thoughts, strength, etc. Practice turning these verses into prayers for test takers.

Example: **Psalm 56:3** When I am afraid, I will trust in you.

Dear God, when I am afraid during this test, I pray that I will trust in you. Thank you for always being with me. Amen.

6. Write your own personalized Scripture prayer based on the following verse.

Philippians 4:7 And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.